

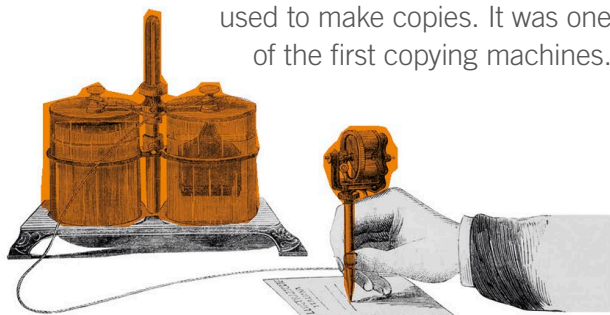
August

8

1876

Electric pen

US inventor Thomas Edison patented an electric pen that made stencils of documents, which could then be used to make copies. It was one of the first copying machines.



Born this day

1879 Emiliano Zapata, Mexican revolutionary. During the Mexican Revolution, he fought for the right of peasants to own land.

1969 Faye Wong, Chinese singer and actor. Also called the “Diva of Asia”, she has written and sung many songs in Cantonese and Mandarin.

1992 Dream team

A star-studded US basketball team won gold at the Olympic Games in Barcelona, Spain. Considered to be one of the best basketball squads ever put together, the group featured top players of the time, including Michael Jordan and Magic Johnson.



1709 Flying balloon

Brazilian priest Bartolomeu de Gusmão demonstrated the first flight of a model hot-air balloon, which rose about 4 m (13 ft) into the air.

Also on this day

1963 A British gang stole more than £2 million from a train on its way to London in what is now called the Great Train Robbery.

1967 The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was founded to promote development in the region.

1988 Protesters seeking democracy took to the streets in the People Power Uprising in Burma (Myanmar), demanding an end to military rule.